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BASIC INFORMATION:

OROP ISRAEL 1991-1992:

A Cloudbusting Experiment to Restore Wintertime Rains to Israel and the Eastern Mediterranean During an Extended Period of Drought.

by James DeMeo, Ph.D.**

Field Operations Team: James DeMeo and Theirrie Cook***

James DeMeo and Theirrie Cook, in a sea of wildflowers on the normally barren edge of the Dead Sea, 10 1992, after several months of exceptional rains which followed their cloudbusting operations of late Noven More photos and discussion follows.

* Published in *Pulse of the Planet #4*, 1993, p.92-98. A previous version of this article appeared in the *Jou Orgonomy*, 26(2):248-265, Fall/winter 1992. Condensed from a Special Report of the same title.(8) All tex and graphs Copyright (C) 1989 by James DeMeo and the Orgone Biophysical Research Lab.

** Director of Israel Field Operations, and Director of Research, Orgone Biophysical Research Lab, PO B Ashland, Oregon 97520. 541-552-0118
E-mail to: **info(at)orgonelab.org**
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*** Director, Orgonics company, Petaluma, California, www.orgonics.com, Email: orgonics(at)aol.com
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Acknowledgements: Funding for this project was provided by a grant from the Fox Foundation. A heartfe Richard J. Fox for his generous support and encouragements. A note of special thanks and appreciation to Cook, one of the principal workers during this project, and also to the members and friends of the Hellenic Association, who undertook coordinated field work in Greece and Cyprus. Thanks also to various persons and overseas who helped with crucial logistical support, information, research data, and other large helps: Axelrod, Dr. Richard Blasband, Schmuel Cantor, Madeleine Gassner, Pinchas Rimon, Prof. Moshe Tal, an Yoash Tsiddon.

Background to Israel Cloudbusting Operations:
Drought and Water Crisis in the East Mediterranean

During a normal rainy season, from two to four major cyclonic storms may push east across the Mediterranean S make landfall in Israel each month. However, the winter rainy seasons for all years since 1988 had been subnorn cyclonic storms entered the area during these years, and all the nations of the Eastern Mediterranean had been su drought. This, in addition to a lack of adequate water conservation methods in virtually all nations of the area, le progressive decline in groundwater reserves and a lowering of the level of Israel's primary reservoir, Lake Kinne Galilee). By mid-January 1991, when a third year of drought was imminent, the level of Lake Kinneret was at a record low.(1) The lake supplies roughly a third of Israel's agricultural and domestic water needs, the other two t coming from groundwater and wells - however, with scanty rains, groundwater had also been rapidly drained by and Palestinian farmers. A similar incessant exploitation of remaining groundwater reserves had been under way neighboring Jordan, Syria and Lebanon. Salt water intrusion was increasingly affecting coastal wells due to over inland, and salt springs threatened to further contaminate sweet water supplies, even in Lake Kinneret. The lake also losing fish stock, due to drying up of lakeshore breeding grounds, and tourists were staying away. To make worse, severe dwindling of water supplies in the region promised to fuel regional disputes between Israelis and r Arab states, given the dependence of both upon the limited waters of the lake, and the related groundwater suppl Newspapers and television commentators painted a grim picture and openly quoted both Arab and Israeli leaders the likelihood of war over dwindling water supplies.(1,2)

The water resource situation had been building to a crisis point over many years, partly due to the drought, but a combination of social factors: population growth in every country of the arid region, increased use of irrigation a and failure to use existing water resources in a conservative manner. In 1988, for example, drought in the horn o to a dwindling of water in the Nile River. This brought Lake Nasser nearly to its absolute low red line, after whi water would have flowed downstream through irrigation canals or into hydroelectric turbines. Some years before Nile river reaching the point of exhaustion, Egypt actually threatened war with the Sudan and also Ethiopia, if ei went ahead with plans to dam or divert Nile waters upstream. Water diversions in Eastern Turkey and Syria simi produced hostile reactions from Iraq and Jordan, both of which stood to lose. Water-rights issues also partly und Arab-Israeli conflict. Both sides have attacked water pumping stations allegedly diverting water from their own Syria once attempted to block the Golan Heights headwaters of the Jordan River, which supplies 25% of Israel's supplies, and this threat was a factor in the outbreak of the 1967 war. By the end of that war Israel gained contro Golan Heights, insuring a steady flow of Jordan headwaters. Israel has continued to challenge the Syrian and Le governments over possible diversions of Jordan River water, and all three nations have unsuccessfully attempted authority over the mostly untapped water resources of the Litanni River in Southern Lebanon. Control of water r has historically been a hot, fighting issue for every nation of this arid region, and the current drought situation ha them all the more.

Regarding this particular drought, rains had been scanty for most of the Eastern Mediterranean, from Cyprus sou for three years. Strict water rationing had already been established on Cyprus, where domestic water was deliver homes for only two hours a day. By early 1991, water delivery on Cyprus was restricted to *two hours per week*.(

In spring of 1991, I was contacted regarding the serious drought situation in Israel and asked what the possibiliti increasing rains or restoring the normal rainy season to the region by using the technique of cloudbusting. After preliminary analysis of the situation, the possibility of success in Israel appeared to be high, an assessment based my own past successful experiences with the cloudbuster in the deserts of the American Southwest, but also on t positive results of cloudbuster experiments in Israel undertaken by the associates of Dr. Walter Hoppe in the 196 1970s (4), and by Dr. Richard Blasband of the American College of Orgonomy in 1983.(5) Both Hoppe's and Bl experiments were followed by significant rainfall increases, although to my knowledge no attempts were made a applications of the technique. Hoppe left Israel in the 1950s to establish a clinic in Germany, while Blasband res permanently in the USA. Blasband was one of the first individuals in the USA to undertake controlled studies ev Reich's biophysical findings (6), and he has led a team of researchers on the issue of cloudbusting. His cloudbus Israel was followed by major rains over all of Israel. Also of significant note were the 1963-1964 cloudbuster tes meteorologist Gad Assaf, who observed significant decreases in the 500 mb pressure surface over the region afte cloudbusting, as compared to the objective barotropic prediction.(7) These positive experiences by others provid foundation for my feeling that the present drought could be reduced or completely ended through cloudbusting.

After reviewing climate conditions for Israel, it was determined that two attempts would be made to use the clou first in November 1991, and second in February 1992. It was hoped that the cloudbuster would complement the tendencies towards rain that would take place at the onset of the wintertime rainy period. Based upon prior expe

the cloudbuster in Greece and California, which have similar "Mediterranean" climate types (winter rainy seasor dry), it was anticipated that successful cloudbusting in the latter half of November would produce a higher than r quantity of December rainfall, with beneficial effects that might last into January 1992. The second operation in February was timed to follow what we anticipated would be the end of any persisting effects from the Novembe cloudbusting. Or, if the November operations were a total failure, February gave a second chance. As everything planned from offices in the USA, the actual dates of operations were determined months in advance of the arriva research team in Israel. Other than simple climate data and a few informal, and often contradictory, opinions of meteorologists given in newspapers, there were no certain long term forecasts for the region - the vast majority c forecasts are, in any case, not particularly reliable. Several months before the onset of the winter rainy season, fc one Israeli forecaster predicted a wetter-than-normal rainy season based upon dusts from the eruption of Mount I the Philippines. However, this same volcano was being cited by forecasters in California, where we lived, to pre than-normal year. Other forecasters in Israel whom we met with privately were predicting another dry year.

Logistical planning for OROP Israel got underway as early as July 1991, when letters and memoranda were draf to various sponsors, volunteers and observers of the Israel experiments, outlining how the operations would proc specific results which were anticipated; these are reproduced in the published *Special Report*.(8)

Atmospheric Conditions in Israel, as seen from an airplane and on the ground, immediately after our arriva November 1991. Heavy dor-haze obscures the atmosphere, blocking the entrance of rain-bearing air masse systems.

The November 1991 Cloudbusting Operations in Israel:
From Drought to Heavy, Repetitive Rainstorms

According to our plans and specifications, a small but powerful cloudbuster was constructed by a private engine machine shop in Israel. It was operated manually, mounted on a truck during transportation, but removed and se ground during operations. Figure 1 is a photo of this cloudbuster, set up and operating on the shores of Lake Kin of Galilee). It was given the name *Sabra,* which is Hebrew for *native of Israel*. The atmosphere depicted in this p representative of the widespread hazy, dorish conditions we observed upon arrival in Israel, on the 12th of Nove The horizon is nearly 100% obscured, to the point that mountains on the other side of the lake, only a few kilom can hardly be seen. On that day, Israeli television announced that Lake Kinneret was down to its lowest point in only 2 millimeters above the red line, due to drought and heavy water demands. In Figure 1, the low water level apparent by the position of the dock at the far right side of the photo.

Figure 1: Cloudbuster *Sabra,* at work on the West shore of Lake Kinneret (Sea of Galilee), Tiberius, Nortl on 17 November 1991, at the time of a severe 3-years long drought. Operations had been underway for aro hour at the time this photograph was taken. The view is to the East. The photo immediately below shows tl landscape from a slightly higher perspective, looking south. Both photos show a heavy dor layer and a low water in the lake. Compare these two photos to the ones which follow, taken several months after rains wer to the region.

After our arrival, several days were required for making final preparations for the work, and also to check out th cloudbuster for mechanical problems. By the 15th of November, and prior to any work with the cloudbuster, the meteorological service announced the onset of an episode of *Sharav* or *Hamsin* winds, which blew from the inte westward, towards the Mediterranean. This was an upsetting problem for us to encounter, as we knew from past that such desert winds would work *against* any increase in moisture and rains which the cloudbusting might brin we had specifically planned the first operations for late November with the expectation that, by that date, the des atmosphere would have naturally moved south, as is the usual case in November. Given the Sharav, we anticipat delayed response to the cloudbuster. By November 15th, the weather over Israel had developed a hardened, dese character, similar to more arid summertime conditions. While it was difficult for us to predict just how responsiv atmosphere would be to the cloudbuster, the presence of the Sharav suggested a delayed response, at best.

Starting late in the evening on the 15th of November, and periodically until November 24th, cloudbuster Sabra v and operated from one location in Israel to the next, from Kfar Blum in the north to Eilat in the south, according schedule given below. Additional cloudbusting was simultaneously undertaken by members of the Hellenic Orge Association in Greece and on the Island of Cyprus, as coordinated by long distance telephone and directed by m operational plan of action was ambitious and bold, but adequate to the task, and necessary given the severity of t situation being confronted. Weather conditions in Israel and over the Mediterranean were constantly monitored f of change in the weather situation, through a variety of methods:

1. The USA-based WeatherFax company provided timely weather maps, via long-distance fax;
2. The Israeli Meteorological Service at Bet Degan and the Rainfall Augmentation Branch at Ben Gurion Air provided telephone updates on weather conditions, and on several occasions we visited the facilities to view the images or obtain weather data;
3. We constantly monitored English language weather forecasts from various radio and television stations in notably the BBC broadcasts from Cyprus.
4. Most importantly, through our own network of personal contacts in the region, in Israel, Greece, Crete and could obtain on-the-spot descriptions of both prevailing weather and orgone-energetic conditions in the atmosph

Information gathered from these various sources was correlated on the weather map and integrated with our own observations, as made in the field during the cloudbuster operations. In this manner we were able to develop a re precise and timely picture of then-current weather conditions - from both classical meteorological and orgone-en viewpoints - for the entire eastern Mediterranean region.

Figure at Left: Cloudbuster *Sabra* being set up for op the Jordan River, 15-16 November 1991. The author, J DeMeo and assistant Theirrie Cook, preparing equipm when the Jordan River was at a very low stage over m Another photo of the Jordan is provided below, after tl cloudbusting operations and several months of good ra exact same spot showing it to be completely covered c flowing water.

OROP ISRAEL, OPERATIONS TIMETABLE, 1991:

Nov. 12: Cloudbuster team arrives in Israel. Preparations get underway. Heavy Dor.

Nov. 13-14: Preparations continue. Cloudbuster mounted on rental truck. Sharav winds develop, dorish condi increase.

Nov. 15: Cloudbuster trucked to Kfar Blum, in northeast Israel. OPERATIONS BEGIN, set up late PM on th River. Cloudbuster also set into operation on Crete, late PM. Winds respond, but dor infestation is thick.

Nov. 16: Work continues at Jordan River site, Kfar Blum. Dor lessening to west, continues thick to east. Add cloudbusters set up in Athens and Thessaloniki, Greece. Orgone (jet) streams active over region.

Nov. 17: Cloudbuster moved from Jordan River site to Lake Kinneret, at Tiberius. Sharav decreasing. Dor sig less to west. Rains over Greece, with new storms entering central Mediterranean. Cloudbusters in Greece are shu

Nov. 18: Operations ended in Tiberius with move to Tel Aviv on the Mediterranean Sea coast. No work unde Israel today; cannot find suitable draw site. Cloudbusting continues in Cyprus.

Nov. 19: Operations resume at noontime in Tel Aviv, at coast. Thick dorish "marine layer" is present. Fog, st light drizzle by late PM. New fronts on weather map. Rains forecast.

Nov. 20: Move from Tel Aviv to Ein Geddi, on the Dead Sea. Set up by late PM. Heavy dor.

Nov. 21: Move from Dead Sea site south to Eilat, on Red Sea. Continuing dor busting. Cyprus work also con Significant rain fronts near Italy, slowly moving east.

Nov. 22: Continuing work at Eilat. Storm over Italy slows, is now a "cut-off" low pressure.

Nov. 23: Long drive back to Tel Aviv, set up on Mediterranean Sea. Rains now in Greece, but not Cyprus. Tı dor is being mobilized, pushing ahead of storms. All workers in Greece and Cyprus are overworked, dorized, de operations are completely ended in those locations. Only Sabra continues operations in Israel. Set up only by late Aviv.

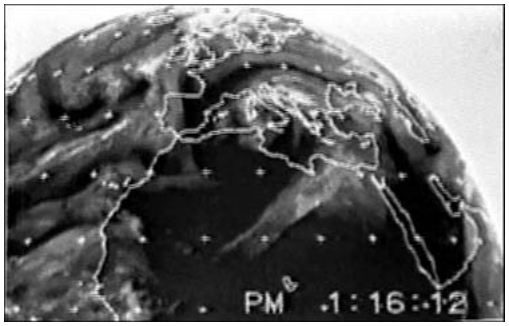
Nov. 24: Operations continue at Tel Aviv until 7:00 PM, when ALL OPERATIONS END. Satellite images ı strong superimposition developing over eastern Mediterranean, as "cut-off" low migrates slowly eastward, towa Lebanon, Israel.

Nov. 25: Storm in Mediterranean still holding together, with rains in Greece, Turkey, Cyprus.

Nov. 26: More dor pushed into Israel, ahead of approaching storm. Meteorologists still do not forecast any si rain, as they expect storm to deviate northward.

Cloudbuster *Sabra* set up and working at the Tel Aviv Marina, one of many locations in Israel where the ap
set into operations between 15-24 November 1991.

Rains began falling in Israel on November 27, as the storm arrived at the coast, and rains continued for the next
to heavy rains also fell across Lebanon, Cyprus, and Turkey, ending only around December 7th. A 50-year rainf
was broken in Israel. It is significant to note this was the very same storm which was previously observed as a
Mediterranean weather front near Italy on November 21, and which developed into a "cut-off low" which movec
towards Greece on November 22. That storm even went "retrograde" (temporarily moved westward) before final
eastward again towards Crete and Israel. The storm's path was unusually far south as contrasted to the path of ot
throughout the drought period.



Satellite Image from 25 November 1991, showing a large
system moving eastward in the Mediterranean Sea. This s
followed right on the heels of the cloudbusting operations
push onshore across Israel two days later, bringing one of
rains on record, and with the most intensive rains of the
Mediterranean region falling within Israel and Western Jo

This rainfall episode, of November 27 to December 7 is plotted on the Percentage of Normal Precipitation map g
Figure 2.(9) Israel, the West Bank territories, and northwest Jordan received the greatest portion of these rains, f
400 percent of normal. By December 7, some Israeli and Jordanian regions had received nearly 90% of the norm
rainfall. The mountains in Turkey, Cyprus, Syria and Lebanon received unexpected heavy snows, and several riv
mountains of Cyprus were flowing with water for the first time in years.(9) It was, indeed, a major shift in weath
conditions, from the previously droughty and stagnant conditions, to a wet and moving, highly animated atmosp

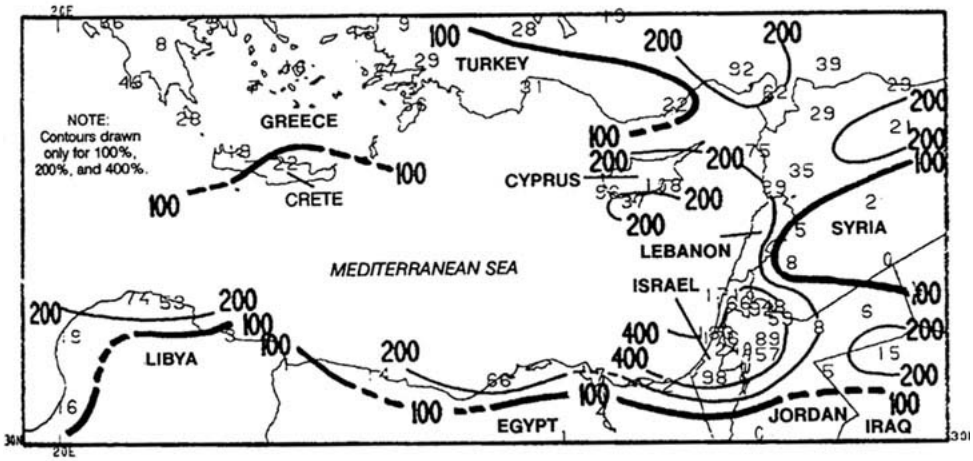


Figure 2: Percentage of Normal Precipitation Map, Eastern Mediterranean, Nov. 27 to Dec. 7, 1991, show contours for the first major storm to enter Israel shortly after the onset of cloudbusting operations.(9) This exceptionally heavy rainfall episode began only 10 days after cloudbusting operations were initiated, and o days after those operations ended. The storm which brought these rains had developed in the western and c Mediterranean as a "cut-off low" on approximately Nov. 21-22, during the cloudbusting operations. It slow eastward, intensifying as it approached the coast of Israel. Six additional episodes of moderate-to-heavy rai entered Israel after this storm, from mid-December through March of 1992, and these are identified on the below, in Figure 4.

After this major breakthrough of rains, a pulsatory pattern of rainfall was established in the eastern Mediterranea beyond anything expected or previously observed by members of the cloudbusting team. A second storm passed Eastern Mediterranean, including Israel, after December 8th. By December 15, the level of Lake Kinneret was u from the red line! Rains were also still progressing in Turkey, Cyprus, Lebanon, Syria, Jordan, Israel and Egypt. pushed into the area with heavy snow after December 31st; Jerusalem received a record 16" of snow, while 24" Amman Jordan. Additional storms pushed into Israel and across the entire Eastern Mediterranean through Janua February 1992 as well, making the planned second phase of operations completely unnecessary.

While virtually all reservoirs, rivers and lakes of the region would fill to capacity, and the water shortages of the be completely wiped away within a few dramatic months, our research team had not anticipated the strength of t which subsequently developed in the eastern Mediterranean, nor the exceptional, even historical quantities of rai snow which fell across the area. Indeed, in my 15+ years of working with the cloudbuster in drought and desert three continents, I had never before witnessed such a powerful response to cloudbusting - the impression gained sudden release of an incredible accumulated atmospheric tension, with an associated shift of climate back towar probably existed prior to the original desertification of the Saharasian region several thousand years ago.

The Jordan River, near Kfar Blum in Northern Israel, at high flow. Only a few months earlier, our cloud been operating at a location close to the center of these photos, at a spot now under several meters of flov

The local populations in most cases celebrated the arrival of those storms, and endured the inconveniences and d of daily life due to heavy rains without complaint; the water was, after all, a badly-needed resource. In some cas people were not well prepared for the magnitude of the temporary weather changes. For example, drainage syste cities had been poorly maintained, and were overgrown with brush, while in others, officials had ignored the pri of hydrologists and urban planners, allowing people to build homes in low-lying, flood-prone areas. When the h came, traffic often came to a stand-still for hours. Previously bone-dry river beds and conduits filled quickly, an overflowed onto major roads. In a few cases, where homes and businesses had been irresponsibly constructed d river beds, water collected and sometimes flooded such structures. A few deaths also occurred on the highways fatal combination of rain-slick streets and highway speeding, or when people attempted to drive their cars throug swollen streams. For the general period of rains, however, traffic fatalities declined in a net manner, as most peo down, and were possibly more alert due to alleviation of prior suffocating dorish conditions.(10) Additional diff occurred in a few areas when power lines were knocked down by heavy winds or accumulated snow, leaving ma without power, sometimes for days.

One major surprise was the high level of agricultural productivity which developed after the storms. From early reports, and from our own observations made later in February, flooded farm fields could be seen everywhere, a anticipated a temporary devastation to the agricultural economy. However, the excess water had a net beneficial agriculture in the region. Aside from providing for secure irrigation water supplies in lakes and reservoirs, the ex flushed away years of accumulated soil salts, replenished subsoil moisture supplies, greened pasturelands, and b many crops which had just begun to sprout in the fields. Orchards which had been previously abandoned due to rains or salinized irrigation waters, and which had died back to leafless twigs and barren stumps, in some cases b bloom again with unexpected vigor and fruit production. While some farm animals, chickens and fruit trees were

episodes of freezing conditions, the abundance of fruits and vegetables was so great only a few months later that the Israeli markets actually declined by 14.3%, producing a 23-year record drop of -0.4% in the cost-of-living st This price decrease was not due to cheaper agricultural imports, as Israel is a net exporter of fruits and vegetable region. However, I do not wish to paint a completely rosy face on these weather changes. In other areas, such as Turkey, and Lebanon, greater difficulties were experienced from the winter storms. There was, additionally, a co factor in the analysis of these strong storms: a very ambitious Israeli government cloudseeding program, employ aircraft and several dozen ground-based seeding generators, was constantly underway during every single storm during the heaviest of downpours and flooding. It was ended only in late February, after widespread public prote the cloudseeding was not a factor in bringing about the end to drought in the eastern Mediterranean (they were s during drought years), it did appear to contribute significantly to the flooding problems, once the cloudbusting h eliminated the energetic barrier to the Mediterranean storms. These problems, as well as operational details and characteristics of the drought-breaking storms, have been more fully discussed in the *Special Report*.(8)

We returned to Israel during the first half of February 1992, the time of the *fifth* major pulse of rainfall - the long most sustained to occur - after the cloudbusting operations. No additional cloudbusting was undertaken in Israel for the reason of water abundance, as discussed above. However, a short cloudbusting operation was undertaken February visit to *slow down and reduce the influx of moisture and energy streaming into the eastern Mediterran* operation was performed at my request and direction by our associates and helpers in Greece, and it was success temporarily diminishing the rains.

We continued to observe and document the ground-level changes first hand, traveling essentially the same route covered during the November 1991 cloudbusting operations, except that in a few cases excess water on the road some areas to routine travel. We even observed some moderate rains in the area around the Dead Sea, and durin snow was observed to blanket parts of the Negev as far south as the hills overlooking Eilat, which is deep within Moreover, several new modest-sized lakes had appeared on the Israeli countryside, having formed from pooling areas which had not received so much water in centuries. These latter phenomena were almost historically uniqu told. Besides the spectacle of the rains and storms themselves, the most incredible and remarkable two aspects w on this February trip were:

1) The complete absence of any hazy, dorish qualities to the atmosphere. The air was not only cool and crisp to walk in, but it was absolutely transparent, allowing unrivaled views of surrounding snow-capped mountains and 3, for example, is a photograph taken in early February 1992, from the same cloudbusting site on Lake Kinneret Figure 1. The difference in the quality of the atmosphere, its greater transparency and crispness, as well as the in height of water in the lake are immediately apparent, as are the mountains on the other side of the Lake, which c be seen the previous November.

Figure 3: Lake Kinneret (Sea of Galilee) under sparkling and transparent atmospheric conditions in early 1992, after several months of good rain. Notice the clearly-observable mountains in the background, the se moving environmental conditions, and the increased height of the water level as compared to the condition November, seen in Figure 1. Several additional photos of the Lake after the operations are given below.

2) The vegetation-barren areas of the Negev Desert, and those regions surrounding the Dead Sea, were in the pro
greening up with grasses and blooming with flowers. In particular, formerly dry wadis (river beds) in the desert a
greened up and bloomed significantly, with new streams and waterfalls on the landscape. These were extraordina
observations, quite rare, and most beautiful to behold (Figure 5). By March 1992, the blooming of flowers and g
formerly-barren areas of the desert were so spectacular that special bus expeditions were being organized by Isra
bureaus, so that people could see the highly unusual phenomenon for themselves.

By the time we left Israel on February 12th, the rains had eased up, to everyone's relief. Only one more pulse of
into the region after our departure, in late February. By the first of March a total of six major pulses of rainfall, e
five to ten days in duration, had passed through the eastern Mediterranean. Through January and February, with
dramatically increased rainfall and surface water runoff, the level of Lake Kinneret continued to rise dramaticall
precious excess water was being pumped from the Lake into previously depleted groundwater aquifers using eve
pump. On February 9th, the Deganya Dam, which controls water flowing from Lake Kinneret south towards the
was opened, allowing even more water to drain away. In spite of the pumping and opening of the dam, by the en
Lake Kinneret was brim full. This raised a fear of flooding to the coastal cities around the lake, such as the resor
Tiberius, and so an unprecedented decision was made to keep the Deganya Dam open, allowing even more wate
into the Dead Sea. It was originally believed that the dam would be open only for a few days, but the waters con
rise so rapidly that the dam remained open for six full weeks, the longest opening period on record. So precious
water flowing into the lake that planners had delayed the decision to open the dam. Even a special net placed acr
opening of the dam, to keep the Lake's fish population from being swept downstream, was removed to allow a m
outflow. The dam was finally shut in late March, after a record 6 weeks opening, but pumping out of the lake int
groundwater aquifers continued. Flooding of coastal towns did not occur. By May and June, the lake was still re
great quantities of surface runoff from surrounding areas, that it was still close to its maximum level. It had prov
wettest winter rainy season ever recorded, since record-keeping began at the turn of the century.(12) Figure 4 pr
graph of daily precipitation values for 13 measuring stations in Israel.(13) The period of the November 1991 clo
operations to bring rain and end drought are marked with arrows.

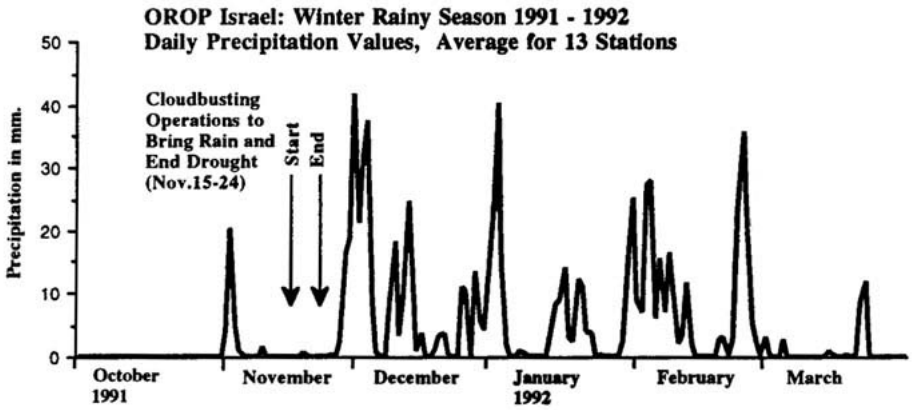


Figure 4: Daily Precipitation Values, Average for 13 Stations in Israel, for the period from 1 October 1991 March 1992. The periods of cloudbusting operations are marked with arrows, and roughly six major pulses can be identified on the graph. Only the first of these rainfall episodes, that of Nov. 27 to Dec. 7, is plotted in Figure 2, above.(13)

Weather over the eastern Mediterranean remained several degrees cooler than the climatological average for the summer months of 1992, and rare late spring and summertime rains swept parts of the region. The following quo underscore the highly unusual nature of these wintertime rains. Figure 5 shows the highly unusual desert-greenir took place in the harsh environment surrounding the Dead Sea.

Figure 5: Greening of desert landscapes, in formerly rocky regions; a sea of wildflowers on the edge of th around 10 February 1992.

Feb. 15: News Report: "*Its official. The current and far-from-over winter is the wettest in a century in Jerusalen Aviv, where there hasn't been so much rain since records were first kept in 1904.*" *75 cm of snow on Mt. Hermo heaviest snowfall in 140 years.* "*In the Golan Heights, snow is considered a blessing... Mt. Hermon is composed limestone, which absorbs water into its many crevices. The melting snow trickles down into multi-year reservoir feed the headwaters of the Jordan river, providing the only source of water to the Kinneret during the summer.*" (*Jerusalem Post* Int. Ed., 15 Feb. 92, p.11)

April 11: News Report: "*The hills are alive again. The winter's rains transformed the face of the Judean Deser all their winters had they seen their familiar pasture so transformed. From the craggy heights where it starts jus Judean Hills to the clifftops overlooking the Dead Sea, the desert was carpeted with flowers and grasses. Asher, guide for the Metzoke Dragot desert tour company, had never seen anything like it either. 'This winter has been other'.*"
(*Jerusalem Post* Int. Ed., 11 April 92)

June 17: News Report: "*Meanwhile, the water level in the Kinneret is remaining at virtually its maximum mark first time since the national water carrier was opened in 1964 that anybody can remember such a high water lev Kinneret in the middle of June. The lake yesterday stood at 208.91 meters below sea level, just one centimeter fr maximum high-water mark.*"
(*Jerusalem Post* Int. Ed., June 17-18, 1992)

"*As a result of the unusually wet winter, we have had a glorious spring with lush growth everywhere and signifi reserves of water both above ground and underground. The Jordan is still extraordinarily high for this time of t*
(Personal Communication, P. Rimon, Kfar Blum, 19 May 92)

"*It's the nicest spring ever in Israel. Flowers are all over the Negev, and people go to look and can't believe it!*"
(Personal Communication, L. Axelrod, Tel Aviv, May 92)

POSTSCRIPT, January 1993. News reports from Israel indicate the subsequent winter rainy season, of 1992-1 an exceptionally wet one for the entire eastern Mediterranean, even though no additional cloudbusting has been The drought did not return, and appears to be ended completely for the foreseeable future.

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PHOTO GALLERY: Click here for additional Newspaper Clippings on these operations.

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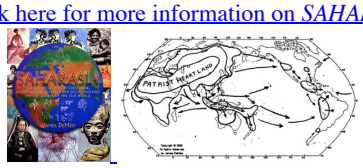

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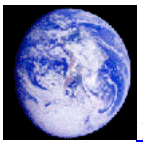
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